



P: (07) 3802 0088

E: admin@stphilomena.qld.edu.au

W: www.stphilomena.qld.edu.au

ST PHILOMENA SCHOOL

Address:

61 Koplick Road,
Park Ridge, QLD 4125

POLICY TITLE:

Acceptable Use of the Learning Management System (LMS) and School Laptop Policy: For Students

1. PURPOSE

The purpose of the Acceptable Use of the Learning Management System (LMS) Policy for Students is to outline the requirements for students when using the St. Philomena School (SPS) Microsoft Office environment, Student Café and School laptop. This policy highlights general principles for acceptable use of SPS Information Technology (IT) approved devices and infrastructure.

The purpose of the SPS Microsoft Office environment and Student Café is to:

- enhance student learning opportunities
- promote student achievement
- allow for learning that is flexible
- encourage learning in a range of schooling and home contexts
- support the professional work of staff
- provide information to Parents/Guardians
- enhance the school's management, information and administration systems
- provide access to online learning environments.

This policy defines the acceptable use of St. Philomena School Learning Management System (both onsite and online).

This policy applies to all users of St. Philomena School LMS, including, but not limited to, teachers, students, parents/guardians, distance education schools and distance education school support teachers.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all users of the SPS IT environment and LMS. To ensure the security of SPS's LMS and the privacy of its users, the following security measures are required. This policy operates in conjunction with SPS Assessment Policies.

3. POLICY STATEMENT

3.1 Acceptable use of School Laptop

At SPS, students are provided with the opportunity to complete aspects of their studies using the school assigned laptop. Each laptop has been specifically assigned to an individual user. That user has also been assigned a unique and specific email address and password.

Use of the school laptop by any student is strictly related to and for the use of school assigned work within the realms of the school's education context. Students using their laptop for outside use such as contacting friends, relatives and or other non-identified members of the public not associated with SPS is strictly prohibited.

3.1.1 Student Laptop Responsibilities

- Students are responsible for the physical security of their laptops whilst in the student's possession. Where a laptop is damaged, lost or stolen whilst in the student's possession, the IT levy remains payable (see 3.1.2).
 - Students whose laptop is damaged, lost or stolen will be provided a spare laptop for the duration of their studies, to be returned to SPS at the end of their enrolment.
- Users are responsible for information system activity conducted under their username and password.
- All users must use only their assigned username and password when using School resources. Under no circumstances should a user ever tell or give out their password or allow anyone else to use their account.
- Students are responsible to ensure that their laptops are fully charged at the start of a school day. This means that their laptops are stored correctly in the power boxes at the end of a day.
- Laptops are not to be taken home. Where a student has a reason to take their laptop home overnight, the written permission of the Principal is required. The request must be made in writing by the student's parent/guardian and approved before the laptop leaves the school.
- The students are to agree that non-authorised software must not be added to the school's laptop without the permission of their teacher and the IT department. All authorised software will come pre-installed on the student's laptop. The exception to this is if you need to utilise a home printer.

- Removable storage devices, e.g. USBs, are blocked by IT policy due to the risk of malware and other cybersecurity risks. If a genuine need for a USB flash drive arises, the IT department must approve it on a case-by-case basis.
- Students found playing games or otherwise misusing their laptop will be locked out of their student account for one school day or a length of time as directed by the Head of Day School.
- The laptops require regular updates; students are to ensure they do not interfere with the automatic update process. Students are also to provide the laptop to IT upon request for sensitive updates such as BIOS updates.
- At the end of Year 12, students will return their laptops to IT after their final assessments are complete. IT will factory reset the device and remove it from the school IT environment, after which ownership transfers as set out in 3.1.2.
- Any user who fails to comply with the responsibilities mentioned throughout this policy may find themselves either having to finance the cost of repairs/replacements or behavioural consequences for failing to adhere to the school rules and policy.

3.1.2 IT Levy Cost

Parents/guardians are responsible for payment of the IT levy and of any replacement fee charged under this policy.

- An IT levy of \$210 per term is charged for senior students. The levy covers the cost of the school laptop and its associated software.
- The IT levy is charged each term for eight (8) terms.
- Where a spare or replacement laptop is issued, the IT levy remains payable for the balance of the eight (8) terms.
- Transfer of ownership: once the IT levy has been paid in full and the laptop has been returned, factory reset and removed from the school IT environment after the student's final assessments, ownership of the laptop transfers to a person nominated in writing by the parent/guardian. Any remaining manufacturer's warranty transfers with the laptop. The school provides no warranty, support or servicing for the laptop after transfer.

3.1.3 Acceptable use of the School LMS

Students should:

3.1.3.1 Respect Learning Resources

- Use the LMS for educational purposes only
- Follow teacher instructions when accessing files, programs and Internet resources via the College LMS

- Always respond appropriately and with respect when engaging verbally or in written form using the College LMS
- Seek advice from the College or their teacher before responding to online prompts from other unknown sources outside the College LMS including from other students or teachers.

3.1.3.2 Respect Others

- Students will respect the rights and opinions of others.
- Follow the Course Classroom and / or online expectations. Students will:
 1. Make time to complete all assigned tasks according to the teacher's instructions.
 2. Complete all tasks in a timely manner by the due date and time.
 3. Always try their best.
 4. Pay attention, participate, ask questions, offer peer support and seek answers.
 5. Actively seek help and support of the teacher prior to the assigned task due date
 6. Actively engage in all assigned tasks including individual, group, collaborative, and teacher-led activities.
 7. Engage in all online/LMS activities in a respectful, positive and appropriate manner.
 8. Be on time and active in the learning environment.
 9. Communicate with the teacher respectfully and apply all feedback provided.
 10. Abide by all IT rules and online etiquette.
 11. Do not impersonate anyone online, including representing yourself as anyone other than yourself in the online environment. This includes your profile picture, which must either be the generic image supplied with your profile or an actual photo of yourself. Any other profile picture is not acceptable.
- Follow the Course Tutorial and/or Discussion Expectations. Student will:
 1. Participate in a positive, respectful and appropriate manner.
 2. Be an active member of a team who supports their peers to work together rather than compete.
 3. Actively listen to others; everyone's contribution matters.
 4. Be respectful to everyone, even if they don't agree.
 5. Allow all students to participate, it is the right of the class to learn and no one student should try to take over or talk too much.
 6. Allow others time to think and respond – no interruptions when others are sharing; however, it is a student's right to ask the teacher or their peers for help when needed.
 7. Come prepared – all research, readings, support notes, question starters and pre-work have been completed so that all students can effectively contribute.
- Observe copyright and academic integrity rules by respecting the information, ideas and artistic works of others and acknowledging all sources appropriately.

3.1.3.3 Keep Themselves Safe Online by

- Keeping their passwords and personal work secure
- Using the LMS for educational purposes only
- Seeking teacher advice before providing personal details to anyone, even if they are in the online class
- Always obtain teacher permission before publishing any personal information or photos online via the School LMS
- St. Philomena School teachers will never ask a student for their personal details or private login and LMS access. If a request is made, please report it to St. Philomena School Principal immediately. The IT department may request a student to log in to their device for maintenance or to facilitate a check of school devices (under the direction of the school Principal).
- Advise St. Philomena School immediately if inappropriate materials are found on the LMS or an unknown person attempts to access your information via the LMS.

3.2 Unacceptable use of the St. Philomena School LMS

Students should not:

3.2.1 Compromise Personal Safety

- Send or post detailed personal contact information, images or audio about themselves or other people via the School LMS. Personal contact information includes addresses of home, school or work, telephone or mobile number, email addresses, social media contacts etc.

3.2.2 Conduct Illegal Activities

Students need to be aware that they are subject to laws relating to assault, trafficking and computer offences. An electronic audit trail may provide evidence of offences. Students should not:

- Attempt to gain unauthorised access to any LMS site or connected app, computer system, network or service, to which they do not have authority. This includes attempting to log in through another person's account or accessing another person's files or details
- Make deliberate attempts to disrupt another person's use of the LMS
- Make deliberate attempts to destroy data by hacking, spreading computer viruses or by any other means
- Engage in any illegal and criminal acts, such as:
 - threaten the personal safety of others
 - arranging a drug sale or the purchase of alcohol
 - taking, selling or re-distributing personal images of others

3.2.3 Breach LMS Security by

- Sharing their password with any other student(s). Breach of this will ensure that all students involved will receive a disciplinary consequence
- Providing their password to another person or in response to a request via email (even if it appears as if the email comes from someone they know)

- Posting information that, if acted upon, could cause damage to, or disrupt the LMS
- Opening posts or LMS communications from unknown sources.

3.2.4 Use Inappropriate Language

Restrictions against 'inappropriate language' apply to public messages, private messages, and material posted on the St. Philomena School LMS. Students should not use disrespectful or inappropriate language including rude, obscene, profane, threatening, racist, and sexist language.

NOTE: Messages, information and posts sent using the schools LMS are monitored.

3.2.5 Disrespect the Privacy of Others by

- Taking photos, sound or video recordings of people, including background figures and voices, without their permission
- Distributing private information, including photos or recordings, about another person without their permission.

3.2.6 Show a Lack of Respect for others by

- Making personal attacks on another person
- Harassing another person. Harassment is persistently acting in a manner that distresses or annoys another person. Any student who is asked to refrain from sending messages, posts or other forms of communication via the LMS to another person should comply with that request immediately.
- Sending or posting any inappropriate or inaccurate information, comments, images, video or audio about other people or organisations.
- Sending or posting personal information about other people without their permission.

3.2.7 Disrespecting School resources by: `

- Using the College LMS for anything other than educational activities
- Downloading or sending files to another person
- Posting, responding or engaging in "spamming" which is sending an annoying or unnecessary message to a large number of people via the College LMS.

3.2.8 Plagiarise or violate copyright laws by:

- Plagiarising works found on the Internet. Plagiarism is taking the ideas or writings of others and presenting them as if they were original to the user
- Using material from the LMS in a manner, which violates copyright laws. All content should be properly referenced and permission from the Author(s) should be obtained where necessary before using any published content.
- Use of any AI (Artificial Intelligence) tool to produce student work in any manner whatsoever.

3.2.9 Access to inappropriate materials

Attempts to access inappropriate material using the schools LMS are monitored and logged by the School. Some inappropriate material may be filtered or blocked by the School. Students must not use or upload to the School LMS materials that:

- are profane or obscene
- encourages illegal acts
- encourages violence or discrimination towards other people
- participates in online chats, discussion groups, or mailing lists that are not part of the course activities
- access material which are not relevant to their education
- uses the school LMS to purchase order or sell any goods.

3.2.10 Use of Instant Messaging Services

The use of messaging Apps and services including the MS Teams chat function is forbidden. The sole exception is chats initiated by teachers in the Distance Learning or Distance Education context.

3.3 Notification

Students should:

- Disclose to their teacher any information that they receive that is inappropriate or disturbing
- Notify the School front desk, if they identify a possible security problem
- Notify the Teacher if they are offended by another person's use of the School LMS.

3.4 Consequences of Improper Use

If a student breaches the LMS Acceptable Use Policy for Students, the following consequences may occur:

- The student may be restricted in their access to materials and online tutorials, virtual classes and discussions
- Students may face a ban from using the School LMS and laptop for a period of up to 10 weeks
- In the case of each breach a letter will be sent to parents/guardians/base-school informing them of the breach and subsequent sanctions. Parents/guardians/base-school will be required to acknowledge receipt of the letter by returning an acknowledgement email to the St. Philomena School Principal.
- In the case of serious breaches, parents/guardians/base-school will be invited to the School in person or via a team meeting to discuss the matter with the Principal or Head of School.

Sanctions resulting from breaches could include:

- a verbal or written warning to the student
- restrictions placed on students' use of the LMS
- suspension from the School LMS for a set period of time
- suspension from the School for a set period of time
- Police involvement for any illegal activities.

4. DEFINITIONS

Breach: an act of breaking or failing to observe a law, agreement, or code of conduct.

Course: An online class is a course conducted over the Internet. They are generally conducted through a learning management system, in which students can view their course syllabus and academic progress, as well as communicate with fellow students and their course teacher.

Distance Education: Classes that are delivered remotely by Riverside Christian College to students of St. Philomena School.

Distance Learning: refers to St Philomena School of Distance Learning.

Harassment: persistently acting in a manner that distresses or annoys another person.

Learning Management System (LMS): A learning management system is a software application for the administration, documentation, tracking, reporting, automation and delivery of educational courses. At St. Philomena School this includes Student Café, Microsoft Office Suite and Turn it in.

Netiquette: refers to the guidelines and etiquette for online communication.

Online Learning - Blends online and direct teacher input (via virtual classroom and online tutorials).

Onsite Learning - All of the course is delivered face-to-face onsite at St. Philomena School.

Plagiarism: is taking the ideas or writings of others and presenting them as if they were original to the user.

Post: a piece of writing, image, or other item of content published online.

Spam: irrelevant or unsolicited messages sent over the internet, typically to a large number of users.

Student's possession: On school days between the hours of 8am and 3pm, when the student has retrieved their laptop from the laptop box until it is returned to the laptop box.

User: A user is a person who utilises a computer or network service.

5. RESPONSIBILITIES

Area of Responsibility	Person Responsible
Maintaining the relevant course within the LMS and ensuring student safety whilst in use.	Teacher
Management of the LMS and ensuring student safety at all times	Teacher/ Head of School
Management of reported breaches	IT Technician/ Teacher/ Head of School
Management of serious breaches and implementation of consequences	IT Technician/ Head of School/ Principal



P: (07) 3802 0088

E: admin@stphilomena.qld.edu.au

W: www.stphilomena.qld.edu.au

ST PHILOMENA SCHOOL

Address:

61 Koplick Road,
Park Ridge, QLD 4125

USER AGREEMENT - STUDENT

- Students are responsible for the physical security of their laptops whilst in the student's possession. Where a laptop is damaged, lost or stolen whilst in the student's possession, the IT levy remains payable.
- Students whose laptop is damaged, lost, or stolen will be provided with a spare laptop for the duration of their studies, to be returned to SPS at the end of their enrolment.
- An IT levy of \$210 per term is charged for senior students. The levy covers the cost of the school laptop and its associated software. The levy is charged each term for eight (8) terms.
- My parent/guardian is responsible for payment of the IT levy and of any replacement fee charged under this policy.
- **Users are responsible for information system activity conducted under their username and password.**
- All users must use only their assigned username and password when using School resources. Under no circumstances should a user ever tell or give out his or her password or allow anyone else to use your account.
- Students are responsible for ensuring that their laptops are fully charged at the start of a school day. This means that their laptops are stored correctly in the power boxes at the end of the day.
- Laptops are not to be taken home. Where a student has a reason to take their laptop home overnight, the written permission of the Principal is required. The request must be made in writing by the student's parent/guardian and approved before the laptop leaves the school.
- The students are to agree that non-authorized software must not be added to the school's laptop without the permission of their teacher and the IT department. All authorized software will come pre-installed on the student's laptop. The exception to this is if you need to utilise a home printer.
- Removable storage devices, e.g. USBs, are blocked by IT policy due to the risk of malware and other cybersecurity risks.
- Students found playing games on their school account will be locked out of their account for one school day or a length of time determined by the Head of Day School.
- The laptops require regular updates; students are to ensure that they do not interfere with the automatic update process. Students are to provide the laptop to IT upon request for sensitive updates such as BIOS updates.
- At the end of Year 12, students will return their laptops to IT after their final assessments are complete. IT will factory reset the device and remove it from the school IT environment, after which ownership transfers as set out in 3.1.2.

- Ownership of the laptop, together with any remaining manufacturer's warranty, transfers to a person nominated in writing by my parent/guardian once the IT levy has been paid in full and the laptop has been returned, reset and removed from the school IT environment. IT will request the necessary details for warranty transfer. The school provides no warranty, support, or service after transfer.
- I acknowledge that access to school resources is a privilege, not a right.

By signing below, I agree to abide by the requirements set forth above for the type of access to School provided computer resources. I specifically agree to the monitoring of communications and security provisions set forth above. I understand that any violation of this agreement may result in loss of access or services, disciplinary action, termination of enrolment, or prosecution:

Parent/Guardian: by signing below, I acknowledge that I am responsible for payment of the IT levy of \$210 per term for eight (8) terms.

Laptop Name:		Laptop Serial Number:	
--------------	--	-----------------------	--

	<u>Name:</u>	<u>Signature:</u>	<u>Date:</u>
Student			
Parent/Guardian			
Head of School			
Principal			

6. REFERENCES

Australian Cyber Safety Centre (2024) *Protect yourself online: A guide to cyber security for young people*. Retrieved on 14th August 2026 from: <https://www.cyber.gov.au/protect-yourself/staying-secure-online/protecting-your-family/protect-yourself-online>

Australian Government (2023) *Protecting your family*. Retrieved on 14th August 2026 from: <https://www.cyber.gov.au/acsc/individuals-and-families>

ESafety Commissioner (2026) *Report Cyberbullying*. Retrieved on 14th August 2026 from: <https://www.esafety.gov.au/key-topics/cyberbullying>

Queensland Government (2026) Department of Education Use of ICT services, facilities and devices procedure. Retrieved on 14th August 2026 from: <https://ppr.qed.qld.gov.au/pp/use-of-ict-services-facilities-and-devices-procedure>

7. RELATED DOCUMENTS

Not applicable